

Living Happily Never After

THE VOID BETWEEN THE DREAM OF HONEYMOON AND THE REALITY OF MARRIAGE HAS TO BE FILLED BY RECLAIMING FRIENDSHIP, THE BIRTHRIGHT OF EVERY COUPLE

■ By Priya Sarukkai Chabria

Your hands were made to cup my face!" a delighted young lover exclaims in the American musical *Finian's Rainbow*. This is among the most beautiful thoughts I've come across on the awakening of love and sexual desire.

Yet, a sag in emotions, something like a concavity of despair, even depression, often follows passion. The INDIA TODAY AC Nielsen-ORG-MARG survey announces that post-marital depression is on the rise, through every phase of married life. Why is it so? The phenomena that attend erotic love interest me, not so much their sociological manifestations, though various life situations impact differently, and, of course, should be studied. I, however, see the issue primarily as a philosophical

Do you find your wife somewhat less attractive after childbirth?



All figures in per cent.
Rest: Don't know/Won't say